

Absolutely. I've reviewed the reference PDF, and I'll use **that as the benchmark from now on**: exhaustive modern senses, established constructions/compounds, useful family members, specialist-but-still-relevant meanings, second-pass distinctions, and a master comparison—while avoiding artificial derivatives or obsolete trivia. That matches the reference's own principle of grouping “established related forms and useful constructions” and then doing a family-extension sweep plus master comparison.

So moving forward, I'll push each word closer to the **fullest practical modern polysemy map** rather than stopping once the main IELTS senses are covered.

Word family: **department / departments / departmental / departmentally / interdepartmental / intradepartmental / departmentalize / departmentalization**

Base word: department

Part of speech: mainly **noun**

Related forms:

department (n.) — 部門；科 / 系；政府部門；專櫃 / 商品部；行政區

departmental (adj.) — 部門的；學系的；政府部門的

departmentally (adv.) — 按部門地；在部門層面上（較正式）

interdepartmental (adj.) — 跨部門的；部門之間的

intradepartmental (adj.) — 部門內部的

departmentalize / departmentalise (v.) — 把組織劃分成部門

departmentalization / departmentalisation (n.) — 部門化；按職能劃分部門

Useful expressions / extensions:

a department of a company

marketing department

finance department

sales department

HR department

operations department

IT department

legal department

customer service department

department head

head of department

department manager

department meeting

department budget

department policy

departmental structure

departmental responsibility

interdepartmental communication

* **interdepartmental cooperation**
* **academic department**
* **university department**
* **Department of English**
* **department chair**
* **government department**
* **government department / ministry**
* **police department**
* **fire department**
* **health department**
* **department store**
* **men's / cosmetics / furniture department**
* **hospital department**
* **emergency department**
* **outpatient department**
* **a department of knowledge / activity**
* **that's not my department**
* **administrative department / département**
* **departmentalization by function / product / geography**

Meaning in this passage

> This problem is especially serious in large organisations, where **departments** such as marketing, finance and operations may use different professional language and priorities.

Here, **departments** means:

separate functional units within a larger organisation, each responsible for a particular type of work — 部門；職能部門

Marketing, finance, and operations are different organizational divisions with their own responsibilities, vocabulary, priorities, and working methods.

中文翻譯：

這個問題在大型機構中特別嚴重，因為市場推廣、財務和營運等不同**部門**可能使用不同的專業語言，亦有不同的優先事項。

So here:

department = 大型組織內負責某一類特定工作的正式單位

A. ORGANISATIONAL / WORKPLACE DEPARTMENTS

1. **department = functional unit in an organisation — 部門；職能單位**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Different **departments** may use different professional language.

不同**部門**可能使用不同的專業語言。

Practice 2

> Each **department** has its own responsibilities.

每個**部門**都有自己的職責。

Practice 3

> The project involves several **departments**.

這個項目涉及數個**部門**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****department = 大型公司或機構內負責某一類特定工作的正式單位****

2. **marketing department — 市場推廣 / 市場營銷部**

Practice 1

> The **marketing department** is preparing the new campaign.

****市場推廣部**正在準備新的宣傳活動。**

Practice 2

> The product team consulted the **marketing department**.

產品團隊諮詢了**市場部**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****marketing department = 負責市場研究、品牌、推廣和宣傳等工作的部門****

3. **finance department — 財務部**

Practice 1

> The **finance department** approved the budget.

財務部批准了預算。

Practice 2

> Please send the invoice to the **finance department**.

請把發票交給**財務部**。

MCQ-ready definition:

finance department = 負責預算、付款、會計、財務管理等工作的部門

4. **operations department — 營運部**

Practice 1

> The **operations department** manages daily processes.

營運部負責管理日常流程。

Practice 2

> Marketing and **operations** had different priorities.

市場部和**營運部**有不同的優先事項。

MCQ-ready definition:

operations department = 負責機構日常運作、流程和實際執行工作的部門

5. **sales department — 銷售部**

Practice 1

> The **sales department** exceeded its target.

****銷售部**超額完成目標。**

Practice 2

> Customer feedback was passed to the ****sales department****.

顧客意見被轉交給****銷售部****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sales department = 負責銷售產品或服務、開發客戶和達成銷售目標的部門****

6. ****human resources / HR department — 人力資源部****

Practice 1

> Contact the ****HR department**** if you have questions about leave.

如果你對假期有疑問，請聯絡****人力資源部****。

Practice 2

> The ****human resources department**** organised staff training.

****人力資源部****安排了員工培訓。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****HR department = 負責招聘、員工政策、薪酬福利、培訓等人事工作的部門****

7. ****IT department — 資訊科技部****

Practice 1

> The ****IT department**** fixed the network problem.

****資訊科技部****修復了網絡問題。

Practice 2

> Report security issues to the ****IT department****.

如有保安問題，請向****資訊科技部****報告。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****IT department = 負責電腦、網絡、系統和科技支援的部門****

8. ****legal department — 法務部****

Practice 1

> The contract was reviewed by the ****legal department****.

合約由****法務部****審核。

Practice 2

> The issue was referred to the company's ****legal department****.

問題被轉交給公司的****法律部門****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****legal department = 負責法律意見、合約、合規和法律風險的部門****

9. ****customer service department — 客戶服務部****

Practice 1

> Your complaint has been sent to the ****customer service department****.

你的投訴已被轉交給****客戶服務部****。

Practice 2

> The ****customer service department**** handles returns.

****客戶服務部****負責處理退貨。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****customer service department = 負責協助顧客、處理查詢和投訴的部門****

10. ****department head / head of department — 部門主管****

Practice 1

> She is the **head of the finance department**.

她是**財務部主管**。

Practice 2

> The **department head** approved the request.

部門主管批准了申請。

MCQ-ready definition:

department head / head of department = 負責管理整個部門的人

Usage note

Both are natural:

> **department head**

> **head of department**

In universities, **Head of Department** is especially common in BrE; **department chair / chair of the department** is common in North American higher education.

11. **department manager — 部門經理**

Practice 1

> Ask your **department manager** for approval.

向你的**部門經理**申請批准。

Practice 2

> Department managers meet every Monday.

各**部門經理**每星期一開會。

MCQ-ready definition:

department manager = 負責某一部門日常管理的人

12. **department meeting — 部門會議**

Practice 1

> We have a **department meeting** this afternoon.

我們今天下午有**部門會議**。

Practice 2

> The issue was discussed at the monthly **department meeting**.

這個問題在每月的**部門會議**上討論。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****department meeting = 某一部門成員共同參與的內部會議****

13. **department budget — 部門預算**

Practice 1

> The training costs will come from the **department budget**.

培訓費用會由**部門預算**支付。

Practice 2

> Each manager prepares an annual **department budget**.

每名經理都會準備年度**部門預算**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****department budget = 分配給某個部門使用的資金計劃****

14. **department policy / procedure — 部門政策 / 程序**

Practice 1

> This is a **department policy**, not a company-wide rule.

這是**部門政策**，並非全公司規定。

Practice 2

> Procedures vary from one **department** to another.

不同**部門**的程序有所不同。

MCQ-ready definition:

department policy/procedure = 適用於特定部門的規則或工作程序

15. **within a department** — 在部門內部

Practice 1

> Communication **within the department** has improved.

部門內部的溝通已有改善。

Practice 2

> Responsibilities should be clear **within each department**.

每個**部門內部**的職責都應清楚界定。

MCQ-ready definition:

within a department = 在同一個組織部門的內部

16. **across departments** — 跨部門

Practice 1

> The company encourages cooperation **across departments**.

公司鼓勵**跨部門合作**。

Practice 2

> Information does not always flow smoothly **across departments**.

資訊在**不同部門之間**未必總能順暢流動。

MCQ-ready definition:

across departments = 涉及或連接多個不同部門

17. ****between departments — 部門之間****

Practice 1

> Misunderstandings often occur ****between departments****.

誤會經常發生在****不同部門之間****。

Practice 2

> Priorities differ ****between departments****.

不同****部門之間****的優先事項並不相同。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****between departments = 描述兩個或多個部門相互之間的關係****

B. DEPARTMENTAL FAMILY

18. ****departmental — 部門的；部門層面的****

Practice 1

> The change requires ****departmental approval****.

這項改動需要****部門批准****。

Practice 2

> Each team has different ****departmental priorities****.

不同團隊有不同的****部門優先事項****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****departmental = 與某個部門、其工作或管理有關的****

19. ****departmental structure — 部門架構****

Practice 1

> The company changed its **departmental structure**.

公司改變了**部門架構**。

Practice 2

> A rigid **departmental structure** can slow communication.

過於僵化的**部門架構**可能拖慢溝通。

MCQ-ready definition:

departmental structure = 組織如何劃分、安排和管理不同部門的架構

20. **departmental responsibility — 部門責任**

Practice 1

> Safety is a shared responsibility rather than a purely **departmental responsibility**.

安全是共同責任，而不是純粹的**單一部門責任**。

Practice 2

> The document defines **departmental responsibilities** clearly.

文件清楚界定了各**部門職責**。

MCQ-ready definition:

departmental responsibility = 正式歸屬某一部門負責的工作或義務

21. **departmental boundaries — 部門界線**

Practice 1

> Information needs to move beyond traditional **departmental boundaries**.

資訊需要突破傳統的**部門界線**。

Practice 2

> The project crossed several **departmental boundaries**.

這個項目跨越了數個**部門界線**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****departmental boundaries = 不同部門在職責、權限和工作範圍上的界線****

22. ****interdepartmental — 跨部門的；部門之間的****

Practice 1

> Better ****interdepartmental communication**** can prevent duplication.

更好的****跨部門溝通****可以避免重複工作。

Practice 2

> An ****interdepartmental team**** was created to solve the problem.

公司成立了一支****跨部門團隊****來解決問題。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****interdepartmental = 涉及兩個或以上部門，或發生在部門之間的****

23. ****interdepartmental communication — 跨部門溝通****

Highly relevant to your passage.

Practice 1

> Poor ****interdepartmental communication**** delayed the launch.

不良的****跨部門溝通****延誤了推出時間。

Practice 2

> Regular updates improve ****interdepartmental communication****.

定期更新有助改善****部門之間的溝通****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****interdepartmental communication = 不同組織部門之間交換資訊和協調工作的過程****

24. **interdepartmental cooperation / coordination** — 跨部門合作 / 協調

Practice 1

> The project requires strong **interdepartmental cooperation**.

這個項目需要良好的**跨部門合作**。

Practice 2

> Weak **interdepartmental coordination** caused delays.

薄弱的**跨部門協調**造成延誤。

MCQ-ready definition:

interdepartmental cooperation/coordination = 不同部門為共同目標共同工作和互相配合

25. **intradepartmental** — 部門內部的

Less common than **interdepartmental**, but established and useful for recognition.

Practice 1

> The survey examined **intradepartmental communication**.

調查研究了**部門內部溝通**。

Practice 2

> The conflict remained **intradepartmental**.

這場衝突仍屬於**部門內部問題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

intradepartmental = 發生在同一個部門內部的

26. **departmentally** — 按部門；從部門層面

Formal and much less common.

Practice 1

> Budgets are managed **departmentally**.

預算按**部門層面**管理。

Practice 2

> The data were organised **departmentally**.

數據按照**部門分類**整理。

MCQ-ready definition:

departmentally = 以部門為單位或從部門層面進行

C. ACADEMIC / UNIVERSITY DEPARTMENT

27. **academic department** — 學系；院系中的系

A major separate institutional use.

Practice 1

> She works in the English **department**.

她在英文**系**工作。

Practice 2

> The university has a large science **department**.

這所大學有一個規模很大的科學**學系 / 部門**。

MCQ-ready definition:

academic department = 大學或學院內專門負責某一學科教學和研究的單位

28. **Department of English / History / Physics** — 英文系 / 歷史系 / 物理系

Practice 1

> He teaches in the **Department of History**.

他在**歷史系**任教。

Practice 2

> The **Department of Physics** offers several postgraduate programmes.

物理系提供數個研究生課程。

MCQ-ready definition:

Department of X = 大學中專門負責 X 學科的正式學術單位

29. **department chair / chair of the department — 系主任**

Especially common in North American higher education.

Practice 1

> She became **chair of the department**.

她成為了**系主任**。

Practice 2

> The **department chair** approved the new course.

系主任批准了新課程。

MCQ-ready definition:

department chair = 負責管理大學某一學系的學術主管

30. **head of department — 系主任；學系主管**

Especially common in BrE and many Commonwealth systems.

Practice 1

> He is **Head of Department**.

他是**系主任**。

Practice 2

> The **Head of Department** met the new lecturers.

****系主任**與新講師會面。**

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****Head of Department = 大學、學校或機構中某個學系 / 部門的主管****

31. ****department faculty / staff — 學系教職員****

Practice 1

> The ****department staff**** met to discuss the curriculum.

****學系教職員**開會討論課程。**

Practice 2

> Several new researchers joined the ****department****.

數名新研究員加入了這個****學系****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****department staff = 屬於某個學系工作的教師、研究人員及行政人員****

D. GOVERNMENT / PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION

32. ****government department — 政府部門****

A major institutional sense.

Practice 1

> The information was published by a ****government department****.

資料由一個****政府部門****發布。

Practice 2

> Several ****government departments**** were involved.

數個****政府部門****都有參與。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****government department = 政府內負責某一政策或行政範疇的正式機構****

33. ****department vs ministry — 政府「部門」與「部」****

These can overlap internationally, but terminology varies by country.

Practice 1

> Some countries use the term ****department****, while others use ****ministry****.

有些國家使用 ****department (部門)****，另一些則使用 ****ministry (部 / 部會)****。

Practice 2

> The exact title depends on the country's administrative system.

確實名稱取決於該國的行政制度。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****government department = 政府行政單位；在不同國家可能相當於 ministry、bureau、office 等不同級別****

Do not assume ****department = ministry**** in every jurisdiction.

34. ****department responsible for something — 負責某範疇的政府部門****

Practice 1

> Contact the ****department responsible for transport****.

請聯絡****負責交通事務的政府部門****。

Practice 2

> The relevant ****department**** issued new guidance.

相關****部門****發布了新指引。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****department responsible for X = 正式負責管理 X 政策或行政工作的政府單位****

E. EMERGENCY / MUNICIPAL SERVICES

35. **police department — 警察部門；警察局系統**

Especially common in AmE.

Practice 1

> The local **police department** opened an investigation.

當地**警察部門**展開了調查。

Practice 2

> She works for the city **police department**.

她在市政府的**警察部門**工作。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****police department = especially AmE: 負責某地區執法和治安工作的警察機構****

36. **fire department — 消防部門**

Especially AmE.

Practice 1

> The **fire department** arrived within minutes.

****消防部門**數分鐘內到場。**

Practice 2

> Call the **fire department** immediately.

立即聯絡**消防部門**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fire department = 負責滅火、救援和消防安全的公共服務機構****

37. **health department — 衛生 / 公共衛生部門**

Practice 1

> The local **health department** issued an advisory.

當地**衛生部門**發布了指引。

Practice 2

> The restaurant was inspected by the **health department**.

餐廳接受了**衛生部門**檢查。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****health department = 負責公共衛生、健康規管或相關行政工作的政府單位****

F. HOSPITAL / MEDICAL DEPARTMENTS

38. **hospital department — 醫院部門 / 科**

Practice 1

> She was transferred to another **department** in the hospital.

她被轉到醫院另一個**部門 / 科**。

Practice 2

> Different **departments** specialise in different types of care.

不同**科室**專門處理不同類型的醫療服務。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****hospital department = 醫院內專門負責某一類醫療服務的單位****

39. **emergency department — 急症室；急診部門**

Practice 1

> He was taken to the **emergency department**.

他被送往**急症室 / 急診部**。

Practice 2

> The hospital's **emergency department** was very busy.

醫院的**急症部門**非常繁忙。

MCQ-ready definition:

emergency department = 醫院內處理急性、緊急病情和創傷的部門

Often abbreviated **ED**.

40. **outpatient department — 門診部**

Practice 1

> She has an appointment at the **outpatient department**.

她在**門診部**有預約。

Practice 2

> The patient was referred to the **outpatient department**.

病人被轉介至**門診部**。

MCQ-ready definition:

outpatient department = 處理不需住院病人的醫院部門

G. RETAIL / DEPARTMENT STORE

41. **department = section of a large shop — 商品部；專櫃區**

A distinct retail sense.

Practice 1

> The furniture **department** is on the third floor.

家具**部 / 專區**在三樓。

Practice 2

> Ask someone in the cosmetics **department**.

向化妝品**部門** / 專櫃區**的職員查詢**。

MCQ-ready definition:

department = 大型商店內專門售賣某一類商品的區域

42. **men's / women's / children's department — 男裝 / 女裝 / 童裝部**

Practice 1

> The men's **department** is upstairs.

男裝**部**在樓上。

Practice 2

> She works in the children's **department**.

她在童裝**部**工作。

MCQ-ready definition:

X department = 百貨公司內專門售賣 X 類商品的區域

43. **cosmetics / furniture / electronics department — 化妝品 / 家具 / 電子產品部**

Practice 1

> The cosmetics **department** is near the entrance.

化妝品**部**在入口附近。

Practice 2

> I found the item in the electronics **department**.

我在電子產品**部**找到那件商品。

MCQ-ready definition:

department = 店內按商品種類劃分的銷售區域

44. **department store — 百貨公司**

A major lexicalized compound.

Practice 1

> She works in a large **department store**.

她在一家大型**百貨公司**工作。

Practice 2

> Department stores sell many different categories of goods.

百貨公司售賣多種類別的商品。

MCQ-ready definition:

department store = 被劃分成多個商品部門、售賣多種類貨品的大型零售商店

Important:

> **department store** ≠ a “store belonging to a department.”

It is a fixed compound.

H. AREA / SPHERE OF RESPONSIBILITY

45. **that's not my department — 那不是我負責的範疇**

A common figurative extension.

Practice 1

> I'm afraid that's **not my department**.

恐怕那**不是我負責的範疇**。

Practice 2

> Technical support isn't really **my department**.

技術支援其實**不是我的專長 / 職責範圍**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****not my department = 不屬於我的職責、專長或知識範圍****

This can be literal or figurative.

46. ****someone's department = someone's area of expertise/responsibility — 某人的專長 / 責任範圍****

Practice 1

> Legal matters are Sarah's ****department****.

法律事務是 Sarah 的****專長 / 負責範圍****。

Practice 2

> Numbers aren't really my ****department****.

數字方面不太是我的****專長****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****someone's department = 某人特別負責或擅長的領域****

Often informal.

47. ****in the ... department — 在某方面****

An informal figurative construction.

Practice 1

> The proposal is strong ****in the creativity department**** but weak on cost control.

這份方案在****創意方面****很強，但成本控制較弱。

Practice 2

> He's not lacking ****in the confidence department****.

他在****自信方面****可一點也不缺。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****in the X department = informal: 在 X 這個方面 / 範疇****

This construction is playful and metaphorically treats a quality as if it were a store or company department.

I. ADMINISTRATIVE TERRITORY

48. ****department = administrative region — 行政區；省級行政單位****

A distinct geographical/government sense in some countries.

Practice 1

> The country is divided into several administrative ****departments****.

該國被劃分成數個行政****區 / 省級單位****。

Practice 2

> Each ****department**** has its own local administration.

每個行政****區****都有自己的地方行政機構。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****department = 某些國家使用的一級或大型行政區劃名稱****

49. ****French département — 法國省級行政區****

A particularly established example.

Practice 1

> France is divided into ****départements****.

法國劃分為多個****省級行政區 (départements) ****。

Practice 2

> Each department has an identifying number.

每個****省級行政區****都有識別編號。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****French département = 法國主要行政區劃之一****

The French spelling ****département**** may appear in texts specifically discussing France.

J. ORGANISATIONAL DESIGN

50. ****departmentalize / departmentalise — 把組織劃分成部門****

A modern business/management term.

Practice 1

> The company ****departmentalized its operations by function****.

公司按職能把營運****劃分成不同部門****。

Practice 2

> Large organisations often ****departmentalise**** work to improve specialization.

大型機構往往會把工作****部門化****，以提高專業分工。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****departmentalize = 把組織或工作按照職能、產品、地區等原則正式劃分成不同部門****

****Spelling:****

* AmE: ****departmentalize****

* BrE also: ****departmentalise****

51. ****departmentalization / departmentalisation — 部門化；部門劃分****

Practice 1

> Functional ****departmentalization**** groups employees by specialty.

職能式****部門化****按專業範疇把員工分組。

Practice 2

> Excessive **departmentalization** can create communication barriers.

過度**部門化**可能造成溝通障礙。

MCQ-ready definition:

departmentalization = 把組織劃分成不同正式部門的管理過程或結構

52. **functional departmentalization — 職能式部門化**

Practice 1

> Marketing, finance and operations are examples of **functional departmentalization**.

市場、財務和營運是**職能式部門化**的例子。

Practice 2

> Functional departmentalization groups similar expertise together.

職能式部門化把相似專業的人員集中在同一單位。

MCQ-ready definition:

functional departmentalization = 按工作職能，如市場、財務、營運等劃分部門

This directly describes the structure in your passage.

53. **product departmentalization — 按產品劃分部門**

Practice 1

> The company uses **product departmentalization**.

公司採用**按產品劃分部門**的方式。

Practice 2

> Each product division has its own marketing and sales teams.

每個產品單位都有自己的市場和銷售團隊。

MCQ-ready definition:

product departmentalization = 按不同產品或產品線建立不同組織單位

54. **geographical departmentalization** — 按地區劃分部門

Practice 1

> International firms may use **geographical departmentalization**.

跨國企業可能採用**地域式部門化**。

Practice 2

> Regional offices manage different geographical markets.

地區辦事處管理不同地域市場。

MCQ-ready definition:

geographical departmentalization = 按國家、地區或市場地域建立不同組織單位

Important distinction 1: **department vs team**

department

a relatively permanent formal organizational unit.

team

a group of people working together, which may be temporary or cross-departmental.

> finance department

> 正式財務部門

> project team

> 項目團隊

A team can contain people from several departments.

Important distinction 2: **department vs division**

These often overlap, but organizational hierarchies vary.

department

typically a functional unit.

division

often a larger business unit organized around:

- * product,
- * market,
- * geography,
- * major business line.

For example:

- > Consumer Products Division
- > → Marketing Department
- > → Digital Marketing Team

But companies structure these differently, so there is **no universal hierarchy**.

Important distinction 3: **department vs section**

department

usually larger and more formal.

section

often a smaller subdivision within a department.

- > HR Department
- > Recruitment Section

But actual naming varies by organization.

Important distinction 4: **department vs unit**

unit

very broad organizational label.

department

usually implies an established formal function.

A **unit** may be:

- * smaller,
- * temporary,
- * specialist,
- * operational.

Important distinction 5: **department vs branch**

department

organized mainly by function.

branch

often a separate geographical location or local office.

> finance department

> 財務部

> Kowloon branch

> 九龍分行 / 分部

Not interchangeable.

Important distinction 6: **department vs office**

office

may refer to:

- * physical workplace,
- * administrative body,
- * smaller organizational function.

department

specifically emphasizes a formal division of a larger organisation.

> admissions office

> 招生辦公室

> admissions department

> 招生部門

Both may exist, but scale and naming depend on the institution.

Important distinction 7: **department vs function**

function

the type of work.

department

the organizational group responsible for that work.

> marketing = function

> marketing department = organizational unit

This is especially useful in business studies.

Important distinction 8: **department vs faculty in a university**

Terminology varies internationally.

Often:

faculty / school

larger academic grouping

department

smaller subject-specific unit.

Example:

> Faculty of Arts

> Department of History

But some institutions use different structures.

Important distinction 9: **department vs major**

department

organizational academic unit.

major

student's main field of study.

> Department of Psychology

> 心理學系

> My major is psychology.

> 我的主修是心理學。

Do not confuse them.

Important distinction 10: **department vs course**

department

the academic unit that teaches and researches a subject.

course

an individual programme or class.

> English Department

> 英文系

> English writing course

> 英文寫作課程

Important distinction 11: **government department vs agency**

department

usually a major government administrative unit.

agency

an organization set up to carry out a specific regulatory, operational, or administrative function.

Exact structures vary by jurisdiction.

Important distinction 12: **department vs ministry**

As noted above, this is jurisdiction-dependent.

A **ministry** is commonly headed by a minister in many political systems.

A **department** can be:

- * an equivalent top-level body,
- * a subordinate unit,
- * or something else,

depending on the country.

So translate according to the actual institution, not mechanically.

Important distinction 13: **department store vs department**

department

one section:

> cosmetics department

department store

the whole large retailer:

> a department store

So:

> department store = 百貨公司

> cosmetics department = 化妝品部 / 專櫃區

Important distinction 14: **department in a hospital vs ward**

department

functional medical unit:

> emergency department

> radiology department

ward

physical inpatient area containing beds:

> surgical ward

> children's ward

A department may operate several wards.

Important distinction 15: **emergency department vs emergency room**

emergency department (ED)

the whole hospital service/unit.

emergency room (ER)

especially AmE traditional term, often referring broadly to the same service.

In modern institutional usage, **emergency department** is often more precise because it is much more than one room.

Important distinction 16: **department = area of expertise**

In:

> That's not my department.

the speaker may not mean a literal organizational department.

It can mean:

「那不是我負責 / 擅長的範疇。」

So this is a figurative extension from “organizational area” → “personal area of responsibility/expertise”.

Important distinction 17: **departmental vs interdepartmental**

departmental

relating to one department or departments generally.

> departmental budget

> 部門預算

interdepartmental

between multiple departments.

> interdepartmental meeting

> 跨部門會議

The prefix **inter-** means “between”.

Important distinction 18: **interdepartmental vs intradepartmental**

inter-

between departments.

intra-

within one department.

> interdepartmental conflict

> 部門之間的衝突

> intradepartmental conflict

> 同一部門內部的衝突

Excellent MCQ distinction.

Important distinction 19: **departmentalization vs decentralization**

departmentalization

divide work into organizational departments.

decentralization

move decision-making authority away from a central authority.

A company can be highly departmentalized but still centrally controlled.

Important distinction 20: **departmentalization vs specialization**

specialization

people focus on narrower types of work.

departmentalization

formal organizational structure groups related work together.

Specialization may encourage departmentalization, but they are not the same thing.

Important distinction 21: **silos / departmental silos**

A useful modern management concept.

A **departmental silo** is:

a department that operates too independently and shares too little information with other departments — 部門孤島 / 資訊孤島

Practice

> Poor communication can create **departmental silos**.

溝通不良可能形成**部門孤島**。

This is highly relevant to your passage because marketing, finance, compliance, and operations may each develop their own language and priorities.

Important distinction 22: **cross-departmental vs interdepartmental**

They are very close.

interdepartmental

formal, meaning between departments.

cross-departmental

very common workplace language, emphasizing activity spanning departments.

> cross-departmental project

> 跨部門項目

> interdepartmental coordination

> 部門之間的協調

Both are useful.

Important distinction 23: **department as administrative region**

This does **not** mean:

* company department,

* university department,

* government ministry.

It is a geographic division:

行政區劃

Context clues usually include:

* country,

* region,

* capital,

* borders,

* local administration.

Important distinction 24: **department in your passage**

Your passage specifically lists:

- > marketing
- > finance
- > operations

These are **functional departments**.

They exist because large organizations divide specialist work among different units.

The communication problem arises because each department may develop:

- * different terminology,
- * different objectives,
- * different performance measures,
- * different risk tolerance,
- * different priorities.

So **department** here is more than simply “a group of workers.”

It means:

a formally organized functional part of a larger institution

Family-extension note

The **department** family has several major modern branches:

1. **company / organization**

- * marketing department
- * finance department
- * HR department

2. **organizational relationships**

- * departmental
- * interdepartmental

* intradepartmental

3. **academic institution**

* English Department
* academic department
* department chair

4. **government**

* government department

5. **public/emergency services**

* police department
* fire department
* health department

6. **hospital**

* emergency department
* outpatient department

7. **retail**

* cosmetics department
* department store

8. **figurative responsibility/expertise**

* that's not my department

9. **administrative geography**

* administrative department
* French département

10. **organization design**

* departmentalization
* functional departmentalization

For your passage, the exact branch is:

department = a formal functional division within a large organization

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
department (company)	部門	organizational unit
marketing department	市場推廣部	marketing function
finance department	財務部	finance
operations department	營運部	operations
sales department	銷售部	sales
HR department	人力資源部	personnel
IT department	資訊科技部	technology
legal department	法務部	law
customer service department	客戶服務部	customers
department head	部門主管	leadership
head of department	部門 / 系主管	leadership
department manager	部門經理	management
department meeting	部門會議	internal meeting
department budget	部門預算	finance
department policy	部門政策	internal rule
within a department	部門內部	internal
across departments	跨部門	multiple units
departmental	部門的	relating to department
departmental structure	部門架構	organization design
departmental boundary	部門界線	organizational separation
interdepartmental	跨部門的	between departments
interdepartmental communication	跨部門溝通	information flow
interdepartmental cooperation	跨部門合作	collaboration
intradepartmental	部門內部的	within department
academic department	學系	university unit
Department of X	X 系	academic subject
department chair	系主任	university leadership
government department	政府部門	public administration
police department	警察部門	law enforcement
fire department	消防部門	emergency service
health department	衛生部門	public health
hospital department	醫院科 / 部門	healthcare
emergency department	急症室 / 急診部	emergency medicine
outpatient department	門診部	outpatient care
department (retail)	商品部 / 專區	shop section
department store	百貨公司	large retailer
not my department	不是我負責 / 擅長的範疇	expertise
administrative department	行政區	geography
département	法國省級行政區	France
departmentalize	部門化	divide organization

departmentalization	部門化	organizational design	
functional departmentalization	職能式部門化	function-based structure	
product departmentalization	產品式部門化	product-based structure	
geographical departmentalization	地域式部門化	geography-based structure	
departmental silo	部門孤島 / 資訊孤島	isolated department	

For your original sentence

> This problem is especially serious in large organisations, where **departments** such as marketing, finance and operations may use different professional language and priorities.

Here:

departments = 大型機構為了專業分工而設立的不同正式職能單位，例如市場推廣部、財務部和營運部

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 這個問題在大型機構中特別嚴重，因為市場推廣、財務和營運等不同**部門**可能使用不同的專業語言，亦有不同的優先事項。

The cleanest organizational contrast is:

> **function** = 做甚麼類型的工作
 > **department** = **正式負責這類工作的組織單位**
 > **team** = 一群共同工作的人，可跨部門
 > **section** = 通常是更小的內部分組
 > **division** = 常是更大型的業務單位，但實際層級因公司而異
 > **branch** = 通常按地點分開的分行 / 分部

And for this passage specifically:

> **marketing department** → customer/market/brand priorities
 > **finance department** → cost/budget/financial-control priorities
 > **operations department** → feasibility/process/execution priorities

That difference in **departmental language and priorities** is exactly why the paragraph argues that structured communication is necessary.